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STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Mirror large folders fast with robocopy

A guide for IT admins

Always verify these commands with your L3 or L4 before production implementation.

What you need

- Access to Windows Command Prompt
- Source and destination folder paths
- Read and write permissions on folders

STEP 1

Test copy with dry run

Use the list only switch to preview the action

Nothing is copied or deleted during this test

PowerShell / CMD

```
robocopy C:\Source D:\Destination /L
```

STEP 2

Copy files and subdirectories

Use the E switch to include empty directories

This copies all files without deleting destination data

PowerShell / CMD

```
robocopy C:\Source D:\Destination /E
```

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STEP 3

Mirror folders and delete extras

Use the MIR switch to mirror source and destination

Files in destination not in source are deleted

PowerShell / CMD

```
robocopy C:\Source D:\Destination /MIR
```

STEP 4

Enable restartable mode

Use the Z switch for restartable mode

This helps if network drops during large transfers

PowerShell / CMD

```
robocopy C:\Source D:\Destination /MIR /Z
```

Verify it worked

Review the summary output in the command window

Check that file counts and byte counts match source and destination

Common mistakes to avoid

> Do not use MIR on root drives

> Always test with the L switch first

> Check destination paths carefully before running

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